

SERIES DOSSIER: MASTER OF KUNG FU

Phase 6 · Disney+ Series #2 (Saga Two, Series #6, the saga's last series)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Series #	Phase 6, Series #2 (limit: 2 this phase; Phase 6's series slate, and the saga's, is now full)
Phase	Phase 6, The Secret Wars Saga : "Secret Wars"
Real title	<i>MASTER OF KUNG FU</i> (the title of Shang-Chi's 616 series and of his Secret Wars tie-in)
Decoy / codename title	<i>"OPEN HAND"</i>
Premiere	Tuesday, August 5, 2031
Finale	Tuesday, September 23, 2031
Episodes	8 (one a week, Tuesdays)
Episode runtime	45–55 minutes
Platform	Disney+ (Tuesday premieres)
Showrunner	Destin Daniel Cretton
Rating	TV-14
Genre + second genre	Martial-arts action + tournament epic / family drama

Episode schedule

Ep	Title	Airdate
1	"K'un-Lun"	Tue, August 5, 2031
2	"The Emperor's Son"	Tue, August 12, 2031
3	"The Tournament"	Tue, August 19, 2031
4	"Hands of Shang-Chi"	Tue, August 26, 2031
5	"The Schools"	Tue, September 2, 2031
6	"The Elixir"	Tue, September 9, 2031
7	"Father"	Tue, September 16, 2031
8	"Master of Kung Fu"	Tue, September 23, 2031

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose series / franchise is this?	SIMU LIU , the only real actor to have played Shang-Chi (<i>Shang-Chi and the Legend of the Ten Rings</i> , 2021). The Shang-Chi franchise is his.

Character	Actor	Age at premiere
Shang-Chi	Simu Liu	42
Emperor Zheng Zu (<i>Shang-Chi's father</i>)	Fresh casting (<i>never played by a real actor; the 2021 film's Wenwu is not the 616 character</i>)	—
Shang-Chi's half-siblings and rivals	Fresh casting	—
The masters of K'un-Lun's schools	Fresh casting	—
Leiko Wu	Fresh casting	—
God Doom (<i>a voice; the post-credit scene</i>)	Robert Downey Jr.	66

In memoriam: Stan Lee (1922–2018). In Episode 3, a tournament announcer in the stands, an old man in dark glasses, shouts "Excelsior!" as Shang-Chi wins his first match. Shang-Chi bows to him.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Master of Kung Fu</i> #1–4 (2015), Haden Blackman & Dalibor Talajić, the <i>Secret Wars</i> tie-in: in the K'un-Lun domain of Battleworld, the tyrant Zheng Zu rules. His son Shang-Chi lives outside his father's court. A tournament of K'un-Lun's martial-arts schools decides who rules next, and Shang-Chi fights his way to his father .
Supporting comics	<i>Special Marvel Edition</i> #15 (1973), Steve Englehart & Jim Starlin: Shang-Chi's first appearance · <i>Master of Kung Fu</i> (1974–83), Doug Moench & Paul Gulacy: Leiko Wu , the definitive run · <i>Shang-Chi</i> (2020–21), Gene Luen Yang & Dike Ruan: Zheng Zu named, and Shang-Chi's half-siblings
Nerf check	✓ Shang-Chi is the greatest martial artist in the Marvel Universe: a master of every style , fast enough to catch bullets , able to focus his chi . Zheng Zu is a master sorcerer, kept alive for centuries by an elixir, and deadly with his hands .

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	93% . The <i>Master of Kung Fu</i> tie-in's setting and players (the domain, the tyrant father, the tournament) are adapted closely. I've kept the smaller plot details broad on purpose, and the series fills them in.

Straight from the page:

- **K'un-Lun is a Battleworld domain** ruled by **Zheng Zu** (*MoKF* 2015 #1).
- **Shang-Chi, Zheng Zu's son**, stands **against his father** (#1–4).
- **A tournament of the schools** (#1–4).
- **Shang-Chi faces Zheng Zu** (#4).
- **Zheng Zu's elixir of life** (616, Yang).
- **Shang-Chi's half-siblings** (616, Yang).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **Leiko Wu** (the Moench era's MI6 agent) is a **K'un-Lun rebel** | The domain version of **Shang-Chi's great love** |

| **The post-credit scene** sends Shang-Chi **to the war on Doomstadt** | It ties the series to *Secret Wars* |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in the series	Held back (why)	Match
Shang-Chi	The greatest martial artist alive; every style; chi focus; bullet-catching reflexes; can replicate himself in a blur of speed (Yang era)	All of it	—	✓ 100%
Zheng Zu	Master sorcerer; centuries old (the elixir); master martial artist	All of it	—	✓ 100%
The school masters	Masters of their styles	All of it	—	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	In a domain of Battleworld ruled by the greatest martial-arts tyrant who ever lived, his son enters the tournament that decides who will rule next, to beat his father with his bare hands.
Theme	Fathers and sons. Shang-Chi won't be his father, and he won't be God Doom's either.
Villain / antagonist	ZHENG ZU

What the season is about

- **Episodes 1–2: K'un-Lun**, a city of martial-arts schools, ruled by **Emperor Zheng Zu**. **Shang-Chi**, his estranged son, **teaches the poor to fight**. **Leiko Wu** and the rebels want him to lead them.
- **Episodes 3–4: The tournament.** Every school's champion **fights for the throne**. **Shang-Chi enters**.
- **Episodes 5–6: Shang-Chi's half-siblings**, each **a champion of a different school**, fight **him** and **each other**. **Zheng Zu's elixir is the secret of his power**.
- **Episode 7: Father and son**, alone, **in the Emperor's garden**.
- **Episode 8: Shang-Chi beats Zheng Zu** without killing him. **K'un-Lun is free**.

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Battleworld: K'un-Lun. Monday, June 3 → Saturday, December 14, 2030. (<i>It's set before Avengers: God Emperor Doom and airs after it, like Ms. Marvel.</i>)
Where it's set	Battleworld: the K'un-Lun domain (the Emperor's palace, the schools, the tournament arena)
Relative to other films	It runs alongside <i>Black Panther: The Infinity Gauntlet</i> and <i>Captain Marvel and the Carol Corps</i> . Its post-credit scene leads into the march on Doomstadt in <i>Avengers: God Emperor Doom</i> .

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The series' own world

- **Shang-Chi** and **K'un-Lun** join the MCU.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Shang-Chi	His first appearance	The MCU after <i>Secret Wars</i>
K'un-Lun	The domain	Iron Fist , in the future

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Another domain rises	The finale	The rebellion grows

7. POST-CREDIT SCENE (Episode 8)

Field	Entry
Post-credit scene	 "THE MARCH." Monday, January 6, 2031, dawn. Outside K'un-Lun's gates, the rebellion is marching past: Thors overhead, Hulks , the Ghost Racers . Steve Rogers rides by on Devil Dinosaur and looks down at Shang-Chi . STEVE: <i>"We could use a man who fights like that."</i> Shang-Chi looks back at K'un-Lun, and then walks with them .
Secret shoot codename	"FALL IN."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scene · [x] The series' own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · [x] **Episode count, runtimes and release pattern**